INTERNAL DRAFT · MARKETING × DESIGN

MV
Business Brand Guide

AI-assisted, human-directed tooling—from pixels to rooms—proven by the games we ship.

METROIDVANIA WORKBENCH

Sprite · Room · World · Export

Version 0.1 · April 2026 · Companion to Company Brand Charter (docs/brand-charter.html) and STYLE_GUIDE.md

North star

Help solo developers and small teams ship **high-quality 2D metroidvanias and platformers** without losing months to disconnected tools. Differentiation is the **integrated pipeline** plus AI that **proposes**—you review and apply.

Proof

Ashen Hollow exercises the same pipeline we ask customers to trust.

Audience now

Early adopters: technically curious indies who reward visible craft over polish theater.

Audience next

Early majority needs reliability, docs, and evidence before they adopt for commercial work.

COMPETITIVE CONTRAST (ONE LINE EACH)

Alternative	MV contrast
Tiled / general editors	Purpose-built metroidvania workflow + integrated sprite-to-room story.
LDtk	Strong manual 2D UX; we add unified AI assist + cross-tool narrative.
Engine-locked editors	Engine-agnostic authoring; export-first.
“Full AI level gen”	Different job—we sell *suggestion + human approval*, not replacement authorship.

Visual system

Shipped tools already encode the canonical palette. **Do not invent new hex colors** in product UI; use CSS tokens from STYLE_GUIDE.md.

CORE PALETTE

Background
`--bg · #050709`

Accent
`--accent · #00e8c8`

Text
`--text · #cce8e0`

Muted
`--muted · #5d7870`

Good
`--good · #4ade80`

Warning
`--warning · #d29922`

Error
`--error · #f85149`

Primary CTA
Gold gradient · dark text #16120a

TYPOGRAPHY

DISPLAY — BEBAS NEUE

ASHEN HOLLOW · ROOM WIZARD

UI / BODY — PLUS JAKARTA SANS

Build the metroidvania you've been designing in your head. The Copilot handles tedious drafts; you approve every change.

DATA — DM MONO

`room_id: R4 · env.theme: ashen_cathedral · x: 1280`

COMPONENT CUES

ACTIVE / FOCUS | SECONDARY | PRIMARY ACTION

Panels: 18px radius · transitions 120ms / 200ms · hover lift max 1px · no colored shadows.

Voice & messaging

Tone: Founder-practitioner — specific, humble about limits, excited about craft. The indie community filters out anonymous corporate voice.

Prefer	Avoid
AI-assisted, suggests, proposes, review and apply	AI-powered magic, autopilot, guaranteed playable output
What shipped + what broke + how you fixed it	Vaporware timelines and feature theatre
Short screen captures and real UI	Stock imagery and generic “gamedev” clichés

PUBLIC CLAIMS DISCIPLINE

- No pricing or tiers without founder approval.
- No promises for features that are not reliable in production.
- Copilot assists authoring; it does not silently mutate shipped player experiences.

Sources of truth in-repo

`STYLE_GUIDE.md` · `docs/brand-charter.html` · `agents/marketing/charter.md`

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